

A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Interview *Ready*

**Prepare better.
Speak with confidence.**

Prepare answers, present your projects and handle your nerves.

8

steps

7

day prep plan

1

confident you

8 steps to *ready*.

Read one step. Practise out loud. Move on.

01 **Know the Interview**
Know what's coming.

02 **Prep Your Story**
Start strong. Stay short.

03 **Answer Well**
Clear. Specific. Brief.

04 **Present Your Projects**
Make them care.

05 **Handle Tough Questions**
Stay calm when stuck.

06 **Ask Great Questions**
Interview them back.

07 **Calm Your Nerves**
Nervous is normal.

08 **Follow Up**
Finish strong.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read a step, then do its action box. Speaking practice matters more than reading, so say your answers aloud.

01

Know the Interview

Know what's coming.

Common formats

- Phone or video screen.
- HR round.
- Panel interview.
- Technical or case round.

What they really test

- Can you do the job?
- Will you fit the team?
- Do you truly want this role?

Research checklist

- The company's products and recent news.
- The skills listed in the job post.
- Your interviewers on LinkedIn.

DO THIS TODAY

Highlight 5 skills in the job post. Write one real example for each.

02

Prep Your Story

Start strong. Stay short.

The 3-part intro

- Present: who you are now.
 - Past: your most relevant proof.
 - Future: why this role excites you.
-

Your 5 core stories

- A challenge you solved.
 - A team win.
 - A mistake you fixed.
 - A time you led.
 - A time you learned fast.
-

Keep it natural

- Aim for 60 seconds.
- Practise out loud, not in your head.
- Know your points, don't memorise a script.

DO THIS TODAY

**Write and time your 60-second intro.
Cut it until it fits.**

03

Answer Well

Clear. Specific. Brief.

Use the STAR method

- Situation: set the scene.
- Task: your goal.
- Action: what you did.
- Result: what changed.

Know the question types

- Behavioural: "Tell me about a time..."
- Situational: "What would you do if..."
- Motivation: "Why this role?"

Answer rules

- Give the answer first, then explain.
- Use real numbers when you can.
- Stop at about 2 minutes.
- A short pause is fine.

DO THIS TODAY

Answer 3 common questions out loud. Record yourself and listen back.

04

Present Your Projects

Make them care.

The 5-part project pitch

- Problem: what needed solving.
- Your role: what you owned.
- Approach: how you did it.
- Result: what improved.
- Lesson: what you would change.

Make it clear

- Explain it to a friend outside your field.
- Lead with the result.
- Keep one visual or demo ready.

Expect follow-ups

- Why did you choose that tool?
- What was the hardest part?
- What would you do differently?

DO THIS TODAY

Prepare a 2-minute pitch for your best project. Present it to someone.

05

Handle Tough Questions

Stay calm when stuck.

When you don't know

- Say so honestly.
 - Explain how you would find out.
 - Reason out loud step by step.
-

Tricky classics

- Salary: share a researched range.
 - Resume gap: be honest, show growth.
 - Why you: match your skills to their needs.
-

Think out loud

- Restate the question.
- Break it into small steps.
- Check your answer before you finish.

DO THIS TODAY

Write honest, short answers to 3 tricky questions.

06

Ask Great Questions

Interview them back.

Questions worth asking

- What does success look like in 6 months?
- How does the team give feedback?
- What are the biggest challenges right now?
- What are the next steps?

Skip these

- Salary and leave in the first round.
- Answers already on their website.
- No questions at all.

Close strong

- Say you are excited about the role.
- Thank them by name.
- Ask about the timeline.

DO THIS TODAY

Write 5 questions. Choose your best 3 for each interview.

07

Calm Your Nerves

Nervous is normal.

Before

- Practise with a friend.
- Sleep well and eat something.
- Prepare your outfit and tech the night before.
- Arrive early and take a short walk.

During

- Breathe in for 4, out for 6.
- Pause before you answer.
- Speak slowly.
- Look at the camera or the interviewer.

Reframe it

- Tell yourself “I’m excited”.
- They want you to do well.
- One weak answer won’t end the interview.

DO THIS TODAY

Practise 4-in, 6-out breathing for 2 minutes every day this week.

08

Follow Up

Finish strong.

Within 24 hours

- Send a thank-you email.
- Mention one topic you discussed.
- Restate why you are a fit.

Review what happened

- What went well?
- What would you improve?
- Which questions surprised you?

Keep going

- Follow up after their stated timeline.
- Keep applying while you wait.
- Ask for feedback if you are not selected.

DO THIS TODAY

Send a thank-you note after every interview. Log your lessons.

YOUR PLAN

7 days. 4 phases.

Tick each box as you go.

DAYS 1 AND 2

Research

- ☐ Read the job post closely
- ☐ Research the company
- ☐ Highlight 5 key skills

DAYS 3 AND 4

Stories

- ☐ Write your 60-second intro
- ☐ Write 5 STAR stories
- ☐ Prepare a project pitch

DAYS 5 AND 6

Practise

- ☐ Do 2 mock interviews
- ☐ Record and review answers
- ☐ Prepare 3 questions to ask

DAY 7

Get ready

- ☐ Pack documents and test tech
- ☐ Plan your route or setup
- ☐ Sleep early. Breathe.

REMEMBER

Confidence comes from practice. Every answer you say out loud makes the real interview easier.

Say it *out loud*.

Jot key points, then tick when practised.

Question	My key points	Practised
Tell me about yourself.		☐
Why this role?		☐
Why our company?		☐
What is your biggest strength?		☐
What is a weakness you are improving?		☐
Describe a challenge you solved.		☐
Tell me about a team conflict.		☐
Walk me through your best project.		☐
Tell me about a failure.		☐
Where do you see yourself in 5 years?		☐
Why should we hire you?		☐
Do you have any questions for us?		☐

YOU'VE GOT THIS

Now go speak with confidence.